



USER TESTING REPORT

Spring 2025 | CSD 1451
Team IDK

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Introduction

Overseas is a top-down, pixel-art survival game, in which players have to catch fish to meet a randomly generated quota.

With obstacles, such as monsters and rocks, players have to navigate the map while managing their two key resources, health and stamina, in order to remain alive. Players will lose upon health reaching zero or upon failure to meet quota.

The goal of the game is to manage resources and maneuver the map to survive as long as possible.



Preparation

Description

The current state of our game includes working player movement and interactions with other game objects such as monsters and shipwrecks. Random spawning of monsters, rocks as well as fishing spots are also implemented, alongside a working quick time event to catch fishes. The two different loss conditions are also set up properly.

During the test, players tested the following:

- Player movement
- Map maneuverability
- Player interaction with game objects
- Fishing (fishing spots and quick-time event)
- Resource management (health and stamina)

Objective

Difficulty/User experience

“Overseas” is a survival game where players have to survive as long as possible, it is necessary to determine whether the current state of the game is too easy or difficult for players. We will see how long the average player survives on their first attempt as compared to subsequent tries, as well as note down what they struggled with most in order to see if difficulty is well balanced.

Stability of game

Due to our game having multiple features and game objects, players will be informed to try interacting more with the game to test each feature’s stability.

Visuals

As “Overseas” has quite a complex UI as well as multiple game objects, it is essential to know whether visuals are appealing to players as well as whether the UI is too crowded or overwhelming

Overall feedback on features

Players will be asked for their thoughts on our game’s features, whether they found it interesting and engaging, what fell short, as well as what other features they would have liked to see in the game.

Survey Form Questions

S/N	Question	Answer
1.	Is the gameplay engaging and all features are working?	Multiple choice from Strongly Disagree to Strongly Agree
2.	Is the user interface easy to navigate/ use?	Multiple choice from Strongly Disagree to Strongly Agree
3.	Is the game too easy?	Multiple choice from Strongly Disagree to Strongly Agree
4.	Is the tutorial easy to understand?	Multiple choice from Strongly Disagree to Strongly Agree
5.	Are there no bugs, and is the game flow good?	Multiple choice from Strongly Disagree to Strongly Agree
6.	Are the visuals easy on the eyes and cohesive?	Multiple choice from Strongly Disagree to Strongly Agree
7.	How would you describe this game to others?	Open ended
8.	How likely are you to recommend this game to others?	Multiple choice from 5 (very likely) to 1 (not likely)
9.	Which elements did you enjoy most?	Select options: Player Controls Quick-Time Events Game Upgrades Score Tracking Customization Other:

10.	What was the most frustrating moment/element for you while playing this game?	Select options: Player Controls Quick-Time Event Enemy Spawn Frequency (Too frequent/not frequent enough) Unrealistic Quota Goals Not enough customization Other:
11.	Was any part of the game confusing for you?	Yes / No
12.	If you answered "Yes" to the previous question, why?	Open ended
13.	If you had to remake this exact game, what would be your priority during development?	Fishing Skill Player Movement Quick-Time Events Event spawning (Monsters, Fishing Spots, Obstacles, etc.) Random Quota Generation UI Art/Visuals Other:
14.	Was there anything you wanted to do/thought you could do in the game but couldn't?	Open ended
15.	If you had to add/remove any element in the game, what would it be?	Open ended

Execution

User Test Report 1

Name of User-Tester: Chen JiuLin

Name of Observer: Lin Xin

Observations:

1. The user-tester was initially confused on how to play or navigate the game as he did not notice there was a tutorial page.
2. The user-tester commented that the health and supply icon at the bottom left was not super obvious at the start.
3. The user-tester struggled throughout the game.
4. The user-tester commented that the slight delay between entering fishing mode and quick time event starting was confusing as he did not notice the player model changing.

Learnings:

Tutorial page is not shown explicitly enough, resulting in the user not noticing it, and ending up confused on how to play the game.

The user-tester also did not notice the health and supply icon initially, meaning that the icons are too small and not obvious enough.

Difficulty level seemed to be too high as the user struggled throughout multiple playthroughs.

Delay between entering fishing mode and quick time event starting may cause confusion due to the minimal visual changes on the player model, more obvious changes may have to be implemented.

User Test Report 2

Name of User-Tester: Pearly Lin

Name of Observer: Mandy

Observations:

1. The user-tester commented that the tutorial page was not made obvious enough.
2. The user-tester commented that when it is night time, the game becomes too dark and difficult to navigate.
3. The user-tester initially did not notice that the health and supply icon at the bottom were changing.
4. The user-tester was unable to distinguish the fishing spots at first glance

Learnings:

The existence of the tutorial page should be made more obvious so that players do not end up missing it.

Dimming effect during night time may have to be adjusted so as to ensure players can still see the game properly.

Size of health and supply icons should be increased to make it more visible.

Number of game objects spawning at once on screen may have to be adjusted to make it less overwhelming.

Fishing spots should have a clearer indicator for better visibility.

Enjoyed the gameplay overall.

User Test Report 3

Name of User-Tester: Wei Siang

Name of Observer: Ethan

Observations:

1. The user-tester felt that the game became hard to navigate due to the night time being too dim
2. The user-tester felt that there was more potential for the upgrade aspect such as implementing a fishing and luck upgrade which makes the fishing minigame easier and increasing the rate of rare fishes spawning respectively.
3. The user-tester struggled to avoid the monsters due to the lack of any warnings before the monsters spawn at random locations
4. The user-tester thoroughly enjoyed the game concepts as well as the player controls

Learnings:

During the user-tester's gameplay, they found it difficult to navigate at night due to the dim lighting, so they suggested adding a small light circle around the player during nighttime.

The upgrade system has potential, and the user-tester recommends adding additional features like a fishing upgrade or a luck upgrade to improve gameplay, making it easier and increasing rare fish spawn rates.

The user-tester also struggled to avoid monsters because they spawn randomly without any warning. To address this, a warning texture before the monsters spawn in specific locations would help.

Overall, the user-tester thoroughly enjoyed the game's concepts and controls.

User Test Report 4

Name of User-Tester: Kyle

Name of Observer: Renfred

Observations:

1. Experienced difficulties starting fishing due to the absence of prompts above fishing spots.
2. Found the game engaging, particularly appreciating its clean and visually appealing graphics.
3. Highlighted customization as the most enjoyable aspect of gameplay.
4. Expressed frustration with the game's unrealistically high quota goals, suggesting they could be adjusted for a better balance.
5. Recommended adding more diverse upgrade options and removing the health bar for improved gameplay experience.

Learnings:

Clear prompts or visual indicators at fishing spots are essential to help players start fishing, emphasizing the importance of intuitive mechanics.

The positive reception of clean and visually appealing graphics highlights the role of strong design in engagement.

Players enjoyed customization, showing that personalization enhances the experience. Frustration with unrealistic quota goals suggests the need for better balance, while adding diverse upgrades could enrich gameplay. Streamline the gameplay by eliminating redundant elements, like the health bar, as the supply bar already serves a similar purpose.

User Test Report 5

Name of User-Tester: Elvis Lim

Name of Observer: Timothy Loh

Observations:

1. The user-tester jumped straight into the game without exploring the rest of the main menu.
2. The user-tester expressed confusion as he was not able to tell if and when he was fishing.
3. The user-tester expressed frustration at the seemingly impossible amount of quota that was needed to reach by X day.
4. The user-tester enjoyed the movement control mechanics of the player.

Learnings:

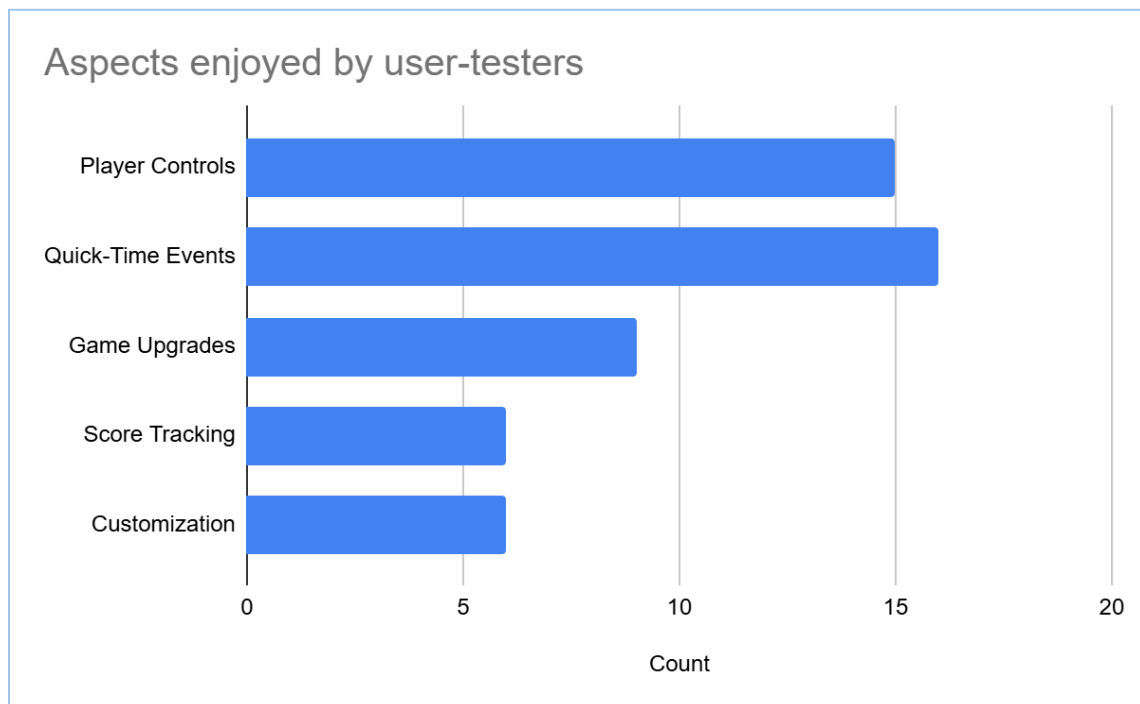
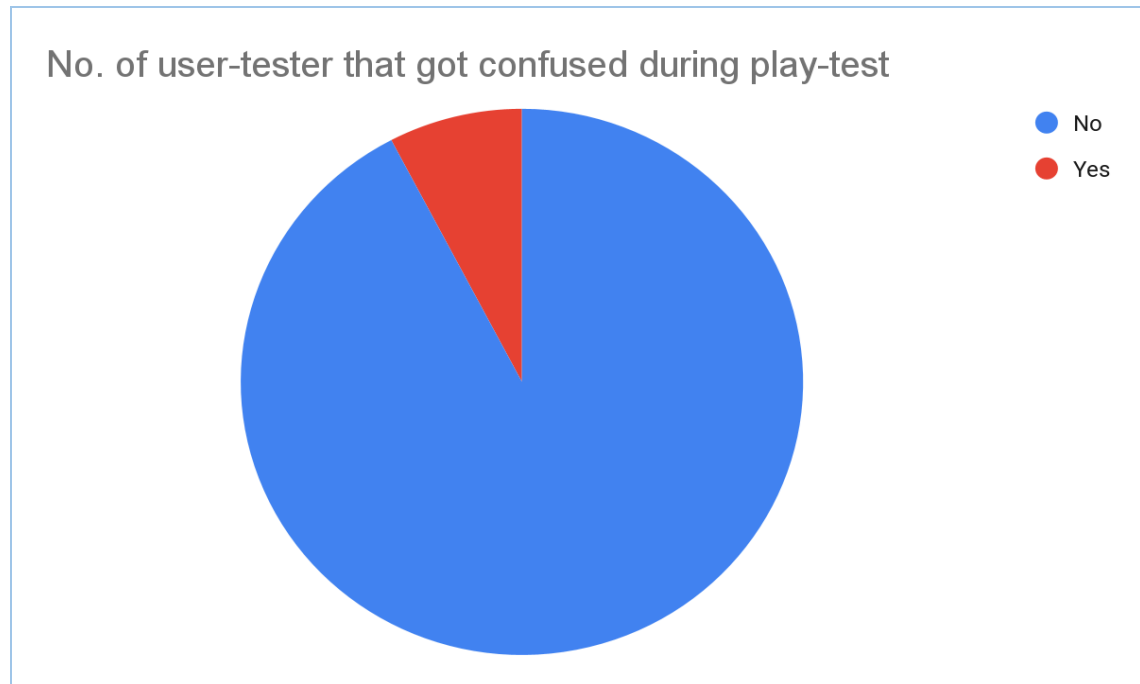
If the player clicks "New Game," prompt them to read the tutorial first.

Additionally, make the sprite change between the "fishing" and "non-fishing" states more distinct to clearly indicate when the player is actively fishing and waiting for a fish to bite.

Analysis

Survey Results

From the play tests, the team gathered 27 different responses from users. Attached are infographics with some statistics.



S/N	Question	Answer
1.	Is the gameplay engaging and all features are working?	Strongly Agree: 16 responses out of 26 (~61.54%) Agree: 9 responses out of 26 (~34.62%) Neutral: 1 response out of 26 (~3.85%)
2.	Is the user interface easy to navigate/ use?	Strongly Agree: 15 responses out of 26 (~57.69%) Agree: 9 responses out of 26 (~34.62%) Neutral: 2 responses out of 26 (~7.69%)
3.	Is the game too easy?	Strongly Agree: 12 responses out of 26 (~46.15%) Agree: 8 responses out of 26 (~30.77%) Neutral: 3 responses out of 26 (~11.54%) Disagree: 3 responses out of 26 (~11.54%) Strongly Disagree: 1 response out of 26 (~3.85%)
4.	Is the tutorial easy to understand?	Strongly Agree: 15 responses out of 26 (~57.69%) Agree: 10 responses out of 26 (~38.46%) Neutral: 1 response out of 26 (~3.85%)
5.	Are there no bugs, and is the game flow good?	Strongly Agree: 15 responses out of 26 (~57.69%) Agree: 10 responses out of 26 (~38.46%) Neutral: 1 response out of 26 (~3.85%)
6.	Are the visuals easy on the eyes and cohesive?	Strongly Agree: 18 responses out of 26 (~69.23%) Agree: 7 responses out of 26 (~26.92%) Neutral: 1 response out of 26 (~3.85%)
7.	How would you describe this game to others?	The game is widely described as a fun and unique fishing simulator, blending relaxing gameplay

		with time-based challenges, survival elements, and skill checks to catch fish and meet quotas.
8.	How likely are you to recommend this game to others?	5 (Very Likely): 13 responses out of 26 (~50%) 4 (Likely): 10 responses out of 26 (~38.46%) 3 (Neutral): 3 responses out of 26 (~11.54%)
9.	Which elements did you enjoy most?	The most enjoyed elements are Player Controls and Quick-Time Events, with frequent mentions of Game Upgrades, Score Tracking, and Customization, reflecting a balanced appreciation for gameplay mechanics.
10.	What was the most frustrating moment/element for you while playing this game?	Unrealistic Quota Goals: 15 mentions (~57.69%) Enemy Spawn Frequency (Too frequent/not frequent enough): 10 mentions (~38.46%) Player Controls: 6 mentions (~23.08%) Not enough customization: 4 mentions (~15.38%) Quick-Time Event: 2 mentions (~7.69%) Too dark/cannot see at night: 2 mentions (~7.69%) Tutorial: 1 mention (~3.85%)
11.	Was any part of the game confusing for you?	No: 24 responses out of 26 (~92.31%) Yes: 2 responses out of 26 (~7.69%)
12.	If you answered "Yes" to the previous question, why?	The majority (92.31%) reported no issues, while 7.69% pointed out unclear tutorials, menu navigation, and success indicators as areas for improvement.
13.	If you had to remake this exact game, what would be your priority during development?	Player Movement: 9 mentions out of 26 (~34.62%) Random Quota Generation: 5 mentions out of 26 (~19.23%)

		Quick-Time Events: 4 mentions out of 26 (~15.38%) Fishing Skill: 4 mentions out of 26 (~15.38%) UI: 4 mentions out of 26 (~15.38%) Physics: 1 mention out of 26 (~3.85%) Event Spawning (Monsters, Fishing Spots, Obstacles, etc.): 1 mention out of 26 (~3.85%) None: 1 mention out of 26 (~3.85%)
14.	Was there anything you wanted to do/thought you could do in the game but couldn't?	No/Not Really/Nil: 14 responses out of 26 (~53.85%) indicated no unfulfilled expectations. Gameplay Mechanics (e.g., better equipment, intuitive fishing, boat dashing): 5 mentions out of 26 (~19.23%). Map Size and Exploration: 3 mentions out of 26 (~11.54%). Customization (e.g., changing player skin, upgrades): 2 mentions out of 26 (~7.69%). Fish-Related Features (e.g., seeing caught fish): 2 mentions out of 26 (~7.69%).
15.	If you had to add/remove any element in the game, what would it be?	Add/Improve Gameplay Features: • Lighting Improvements (e.g., brighter lighting, fishing at night): 2 mentions (~7.69%). • More Upgrades (e.g., additional gameplay elements): 3 mentions (~11.54%). • Achievements/Species Display: 2 mentions (~7.69%). • Add Dash Mechanic: 1 mention (~3.85%). • Combat Mechanic: 1 mention (~3.85%). • Skins: 1 mention (~3.85%). • Random Events (e.g., weather): 1 mention (~3.85%). Adjust Current Elements:

		• Quota Adjustments (easier or lesser quotas): 3 mentions (~11.54%). • Health Mechanic Removal: 1 mention (~3.85%). • Better Controls: 1 mention (~3.85%). • Bigger Map or Map Changes (e.g., not fixed to the window): 2 mentions (~7.69%). No Changes Needed: • No/Nothing/Nil: 11 mentions (~42.31%).
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Positive Discoveries

- User-testers seemed to enjoy the pixel art direction that we chose for the game. They also liked the straightforwardness of the game's objectives, as well as the slightly more challenging player controls. The quick time event was also well received, and user-testers also seemed to enjoy the game's customizations and upgrade system.

Main Issues

- The game's current difficulty level is too high. The day night cycle seems to end too quickly for players to be able to achieve the quota in time. Furthermore, during the night, player visibility is lowered too much, making the game too difficult. 22 out of 26 user-testers gave feedback on the game's difficulty.
- The tutorial was not made obvious enough, 18 out of 26 user-testers did not notice the tutorial page right away on their first playthrough.
- There are too many game objects on screen. 12 out of 26 user-testers felt that there were too many things going on at once on screen, making the game overwhelming and hard to navigate.
- Lack of meaningful upgrades. When asked what they would want to see added in the game, 21 out of 26 user-testers stated that they would like to see more types of upgrades that will help increase their survivability.

Improvements and Recommendation

- Values such as duration of the day night cycle, quota goals, and visibility at night should be adjusted in order to balance out the difficulty of the game.
- The tutorial page should be placed in a way to make it more obvious for players so that new players won't miss it and be confused on how to navigate the game.
- The number of game objects being spawned at the same time will also be reduced to avoid overwhelming players with too much going on at once.
- Addition of unique upgrades can be considered in order to add more variety to gameplay to keep it fun and engaging for players.